

Bible Study - Nicodemus

- Open with prayer
- QOTD: What is one thing you're looking for God to do in your life?

John 3:1-9

- V. 1-2 → A couple notable points in these verses
- First, Nicodemus was regarded as a significant individual
- He was a religious ruler, educated, and influential as he was a member of a high ranking Jewish court council
- This was not just anybody coming up to Jesus
- Secondly, Nicodemus came during the night
- The exact reason for this is unknown, but we can sense a genuinity in curiosity and humility in his heart posture because of this
- Perhaps he wanted to meet with Jesus when he knew they would be uninterrupted or simply in a discreet manner, not doing this for any advantage
- He also acknowledges Jesus as a teacher (Rabbi) from God

John 3:1-9

- V. 3-4 → Nicodemus is confused at what Jesus tells him about being saved
- Jesus tells him in verse 3 that “he must be born again”
- Nicodemus is completely confused! He believes Jesus is telling him that one must literally re-enter his mother’s womb
- He also thought he already had it
- Jesus is telling him, though, that he must be made new (cross ref 2 Corin)
- Interesting point → Jesus did not come to him and say you must stop this, that, etc., he was essentially telling Nicodemus his whole structure must be changed
- We are born into this world spiritually dead due to sin, but we can experience new spiritual birth through Jesus!

John 3:1-9

- V. 5 → Jesus tells Nicodemus he must be born again of water and of Spirit
- It is easier to understand being born of the Spirit... it is the new life that only the Holy Spirit can produce (cross ref 2 Corin)
- Deflated balloon analogy → human spirit to alive in Christ
- Being born of water can be more difficult to understand
- Initially, it can be understood as water baptism, but this is not the case (cross ref Galatians 2)
- Water represents regeneration → this happens at the moment of salvation through the Holy Spirit, Nicodemus would've been familiar with this
- Jesus also could've been using a physical thing to describe something spiritual (GotQues) → Nicodemus couldn't understand spiritual birth, but he could understand physical birth, so that is what Jesus used

John 3:1-9

- V. 6-8 continue on with similar things
- V. 9 ends with Nicodemus still questioning how this is possible
- This questioning is important and the beginning of his faith journey

John 7:45-51

- A few chapters later... V. 45-51 → Nicodemus defends Jesus before Jewish leaders
- Previous to these verses, Jesus is speaking to a large crowd proclaiming to be God in the flesh and about more spiritual truths → religious leaders are in the midst
- They had never even heard anyone SPEAK like Jesus... they wanted him arrested
- Nicodemus, though, courageously defends Jesus and warns the other religious leaders not to judge Jesus so hastily and unjustly
- Nicodemus has now gone from questioning Jesus to defending Jesus, demonstrating that he's beginning to see Jesus in a different light
- The process to this point is not described in Scripture, but very noteworthy!

John 19:38-42

- After Jesus's crucifixion, Joseph of Arimathea and Nicodemus boldly come forward to claim His body and prepare it for burial
- This is important for a couple main reasons
- One, God had used both of these men to preserve and protect the body of Jesus → it was likely that Jesus's body would've been mauled if not for them (Roman tradition → leaving body to animals)
- Two, these men did this THEMSELVES → they were wealthy and could've had servants do this, but they wanted to do this themselves
- Also, the myrrh and aloes were about 75lbs → shows both Nicodemus's wealthy, but also care and appreciation for Jesus

Final Point

- Nicodemus, who once came to Jesus in secret, underwent a significant transformation from curious seeker to committed follower of Christ
- His willingness to risk his reputation and safety to honor Jesus demonstrates a deep faith to identify with Jesus